



Job Abandonment Policy – India

Key Definitions & Related Documents

Key Definitions

Job Abandonment (JA): If an Associate is on unauthorized absence from work for three (3) continuous working days, Job abandonment will be raised in the HCM system by the reporting manager.

Notice Period: Period from the date of resignation till the last working day.

BU Talent Partner: The Talent partner of the respective business unit.

Registered e-mail id: Personal e-mail id in HCM as authenticated by the Associate.

Home Manager: Home Manager is the individual to whom the associate reports directly in Cognizant (formerly referred to as HCM Manager).

Project Manager: Project Manager is the Account Manager/ Client Partner or the ESA supervisor (at grades Manager and above) who is responsible for the revenue and profitability of the project.

Registered phone number: Personal phone number in HCM as authenticated by the Associate.

Separation: Separations owing to Job Abandonment. Job Abandonment (JA) Date: JA date is the first (1st) day after the Last Reported date of the Associate.

Scope

The policy applies to all employees, including trainees, on the payrolls of Cognizant Technology Solutions India Private Limited ("Cognizant") and its affiliates, subsidiaries and joint ventures over which Cognizant has operational control, in the course of employment (collectively "Associates").

Guiding Principles

This policy provides guidance for managing Job Abandonment of Associates.

- The process for Job Abandonment (JA) spans 21 calendar days.
- Job Abandonment should be raised in HCM (Human Capital Management) by the Home Manager whenever the Associate is on an uninformed leave and / or not reported at work for more than three (3) continuous working days.
- Three warning letters will be issued to the Associate as per the JA process.
- In case the Associate establishes virtual/physical contact during the 21 calendar days from the date of JA invoke, the Employee Relation's Point of Contact (POC) for JA will review and advise for proceeding / holding the JA process, based on facts received.
- In the case of resigned Associates, if the Associate establishes virtual/physical contact during the seven (7) working days, the Employee Relations POC will review and advise for proceeding / holding the JA process, based on facts received. If the Associate's Notice period is 60 days, JA can be raised up to the 45th day from the date of resignation and if the Notice Period is 90 days, JA can be raised up to the 75th day from the date of resignation.
- If the response received is satisfactory, based on the Employee Relation POC's documentary evaluation and observation, the JA process will be kept on hold.
- If the response received is not satisfactory, based on the Employee Relation POC's documentary evaluation and observation, JA process will be continued from the day response is received and the warning letter kept on hold will be issued to the Associate with sufficient information on further steps.
- Contact established by the Associate is expected to be with the Home Manager or any other Associate in the Home Manager's upward hierarchy.
- Payroll suspension will be revoked effective the date of reporting physically at work, followed by the HCM records update.

Process

- The Home Manager should attempt to reach the Associate on their registered phone number and if unresponsive, to raise JA.
- The Home Manager should raise JA in HCM on the fourth (4th) consecutive working day of the Associate's uninformed absence. Once the Home Manager raises a JA request in HCM, an e-mail would be triggered to the HRSS (Human Resources Shared Services) team.
- Upon the Home Manager raising JA, the Associate's system access will be auto-revoked immediately, and an e-mail intimating JA will be auto-triggered to the Associate's registered personal e-mail id.
- HRSS team will attempt to reach the Associate on the registered phone number on the 1st calendar day of JA raised in the system.
- The first (1st) warning letter will be e-mailed and/ or couriered with acknowledgement due to the Associate's personal id/ present and permanent residential address in HCM (as authenticated by the Associate), on the second (2nd) calendar day of JA.
- Job abandonment in HCM will be approved, on the third (3rd) calendar day of JA.
- Once the JA record is approved in HCM, the Associate's payroll will be suspended, and Loss of Pay (LOP) will be automatically updated for the days of the Associate's unauthorized absence.
- The second (2nd) warning letter will be issued through e-mail and/or couriered with acknowledgement due to the Associate's present and permanent residential address in HCM (as authenticated by the Associate), on the seventh (7th) calendar day of the JA process.
- The third (3rd) warning letter (final warning letter) will be issued through e-mail and/or couriered with acknowledgement due to the Associate's present and permanent residential address in HCM (as authenticated by the Associate), on the 14th calendar day of the JA process.
- Termination letter will be issued through e-mail and/or couriered with acknowledgement due to the Associate's present and permanent residential address in HCM (as authenticated by the Associate), on the 21st calendar day of the JA process.
- The termination record will be updated in HCM on the 21st calendar day of the JA process.
- A service letter will be issued to the Associate upon submission of Cognizant's IT assets possessed and settlement of outstanding dues by the Associate, as referred to in the termination letter.
- If Associate gives their consent in writing for not continuing with the employment, then separation formalities will be initiated basis internal approvals. Letter with disclaimer on BGV (Background Verification) impact will be sent.
- In case of resignation, if JA is initiated and no response is received within seven (7) working days, the LWD will be propounded, and the Associate will be relieved, subject to internal approvals. Letter with disclaimer on BGV impact will be sent.
- If the Associate commits to resume work on a certain date and does not resume work on the given day, JA will be continued from the same day (JA revoke day).

Responsibility Matrix

- Home Manager
 - It is the responsibility of the Home Manager to monitor the reporting of the associates.
 - Job abandonment should be raised in HCM in case of an Associate being on unauthorized absence for three (3) continuous workings days.
 - It is the responsibility of the Home Manager to monitor the reporting of the Associate and take appropriate action in case Associate not reported to office/work for more than three (3) days in consultation with the Human resource and/or raise the JA as per process.
 - The reporting Manager should raise JA in HCM on the fourth (4th) consecutive working day of the Associate's uninformed absence.
 - EAMS (Enterprise Absence Management System) should be validated for any leave applied/ approved in the system.
 - Trutime data should also be verified by the Home Manager before initiating JA.
 - If the Associate is a new hire, the Home Manager should make necessary checks with the TAG (Talent Acquisition Group) POC for any updates on the whereabouts of the new hire.

- Once the JA has been raised, the Home Manager should ensure timely communication to the client regarding the same and revoke access.
- Provide timely communication to HR, if the Associate establishes virtual/ physical contact with self or anyone from the Associate's upward hierarchy.
- Document the discussion with the Associate and share the same with HRSS for reference.
- The reporting manager has to document the discussion with the Associate and share the same with HRSS for reference.
- In case of JA raised or resignation, Home Manager should not approve the Project Manager clearance unless assets, mainly Cognizant/Client Laptop is surrendered.
- Human Resources – Shared Services (HRSS)
 - HRSS team should ensure that intimation mailer is auto triggered to Associate's personal e-mail id, immediately after JA being raised by the Home Manager.
 - Attempts should be made to reach the Associate on the respective authenticated phone number.
 - Validate and approve the JA record in the system on the third (3rd) calendar day.
 - Issue warning letters and termination letters as per timelines.
 - In case of Associate reporting virtual/physical at work within 21calendar day's then JA process should be closed and payroll suspension should be revoked effective the date of reporting.
- Associate
 - Authenticate the personal contact information (residential address, personal e-mail id and phone number) in HCM.
 - Respond to the communication attempted by Cognizant to avoid the JA process being continued against the Associate.
 - In case of termination, the Associate should close the outstanding dues and submit IT assets of Cognizant in the possession, to receive the service letter.
- Talent Partner (TP)
 - Incase if the Associate has responded to the organization, the TP will be notified of the same and has to connect with the Associate and inform HRSS the next steps in the JA process.
 - TP to liaison with the BU, HRSS and the Associate on decisions taken with respect to the Associate's employment and communicate the same to the Associate.

Exception Management

All exceptions to this policy should be brought to the notice of India Human Resources team and should be approved by Head of Human Resources – India.

Policy Modifications

Cognizant reserves the right to amend its policies as necessary. Any changes to the Job Abandonment Policy will be approved by the Head of Human Resources – India. Associates are required to raise [GSD](#) for any queries.

Version history

Revision date	Description of change
MAR-14-2019	Based on practice and precedence in Cognizant-India.
MAR-14-2019	Introduction of new titles, template and version control.
MAR-14-2019	Change in process and SLAs.
APR-01-2023	● Standardization of template. ● Policy review and process changes incorporated. Introduction of Home Manager action under Responsibility Matrix section.

Policy Control Information

Policy Name: Job Abandonment Policy - India

Department: Human Resources - Compliance

Revision Date: APR-01-2023

Effective Date: APR-01-2023

Policy Owner: Head of Human Resources- India

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